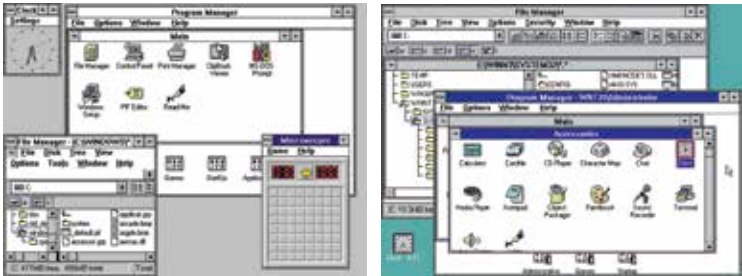


can, for a price. Of course not everyone is going to upgrade to Windows 10, despite it being free, but Microsoft is likely to get a whole lot more people upgrading than usual, thanks to the free offer.

Why 10

Windows 10 makes perfect sense as the name for the successor to Windows 8, in the sense that Microsoft's naming conventions have never made sense. Let's take a brief look at the history of Windows releases to see Microsoft's unentangleable mess of Windows versioning.

After a tepid response to Windows 1.0 and Windows 2.0, Microsoft hit it big with Windows 3 and 3.1. So popular were they that Microsoft made another somewhat incompatible version of Windows that they called Windows NT 3.1.



One of these is Windows NT 3.1 and the other is Windows 3.11 guess which is which (there is a hint in the image)

At this point the Windows line essentially split in two. On one hand you had Windows 3.x that was targeted towards consumers, which was succeeded by Windows 95, and on the other hand you had Windows NT 3.1 that was succeeded by Windows NT 4.0 that was targeted towards servers and workstations.

Windows 95 led to the popular Windows 98, while for inexplicable reasons Windows NT 4.0 led to Windows 2000, which was internally labelled as Windows NT 5.0. With the dates now used for their workstation and server offerings, Microsoft started getting creative with their branding. The successor to Windows 98 was Windows ME, or Millennium Edition, named for how long it would take to accomplish anything on the crash-happy OS. Those who consider Vista a disaster might sing a different tune if they encountered Windows ME.